VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SPACEX DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock

MONDAY, OCTOBER 12, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF FRI OCT 9 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

The SDA satellites fly, and Musk puts a ship catch on Starship's next flight

A Falcon 9 finally launched 21 Space Development Agency (SDA) data-relay satellites from California early Saturday, five days after an automatic abort, and its booster landed back at Vandenberg. Two more Falcon 9s are lined up: Starlink 15-25 on Monday evening, after slipping from Saturday and Sunday, and the CRS-35 cargo Dragon to the International Space Station (ISS) at 6:33 a.m. EDT Tuesday.

Speaking by video at a Tesla fan event in Texas on Saturday, Elon Musk said Starship Flight 15, "hopefully" four to six weeks away, will try to catch the ship with the launch tower. Starlink won a full operating license in Venezuela and offered free service in quake-hit Panama, while Musk escalated his fight with Mukesh Ambani over India. SPCX rose 1.25% Friday to $162.57 as Barclays started coverage at Overweight. SpaceX has filed nothing new with the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) since Friday morning.

I · HUMAN SPACEFLIGHT & LAUNCHES

Third time lucky for the SDA, and cargo Dragon is next

After an abort and a week of day-by-day delays, Falcon 9 delivered the fourth Tranche 1 Transport Layer batch. CRS-35 is set for Tuesday morning from Florida.



A Falcon 9 lifts off from Space Launch Complex 4E at Vandenberg Space Force Base with NASA's SWOT satellite on Dec. 16, 2022. Saturday's SDA launch flew from the same pad.
PHOTO: NASA/KEEGAN BARBER · PUBLIC DOMAIN

T1TL-A in orbit

Falcon 9 lifted off from Space Launch Complex 4E (SLC-4E) at Vandenberg Space Force Base at 3:39 a.m. EDT Saturday with 21 Northrop Grumman-built satellites for the SDA's Tranche 1 Transport Layer, Spaceflight Now reported. Booster B1103, on its sixth flight, landed at Landing Zone 4 about 7.5 minutes later, the 668th Falcon booster landing.

An October 5 attempt had stopped with 58 seconds left after the onboard computers flagged "some off-nominal data on Stage Two." SpaceX lowered the rocket for troubleshooting, then pushed the launch back a day at a time. "Additional time throughout the week allowed for double checks on vehicle systems and range deconfliction," SpaceX launch commentator Atticus Vadera said; Spaceflight Now said the range conflict is believed to have been a missile test from Vandenberg on Friday.

It was the fourth launch of production satellites for the SDA's Proliferated Warfighter Space Architecture. Tranche 1 is to total 126 Transport Layer and 28 Tracking Layer satellites and begin operating for the Defense Department in 2027.

CRS-35 on Tuesday

NASA's 35th Commercial Resupply Services flight is scheduled for 6:33 a.m. EDT Tuesday, October 13, from Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40) at Cape Canaveral, per Spaceflight Now's schedule and Launch Library 2. Cargo Dragon C211, on its fourth flight, carries more than 6,300 pounds of science and supplies, including the last two ISS Roll-Out Solar Arrays, and

is due to dock at the zenith port of the Harmony module on Thursday, October 15. Booster B1096 flies for the eighth time.



Technicians at Kennedy Space Center lower a pair of ISS Roll-Out Solar Arrays onto a platform on Aug. 11, 2026, ahead of their launch on CRS-35.
PHOTO: NASA/CLAYTON ROUGELOT · PUBLIC DOMAIN

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

Starlink slips to Monday; Starship eyes November

Every SpaceX launch on the books for the next two months, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern Daylight Time (EDT); date changes are noted in the mission column.

DATE / TIME (EDT)	VEHICLE	MISSION	PAD	STATUS	SOURCES
Mon Oct 12, 7:00 p.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-25, 27 V2 Mini satellites; booster B1088, 20th flight. **Moved** from Sat Oct 10 and Sun Oct 11 (first Sep 30); no reason given	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Spaceflight Now (window opens 7:00 p.m.); Launch Library 2 (8:11 p.m.)
Tue Oct 13, 6:33 a.m.	Falcon 9 / Cargo Dragon	CRS-35 to the ISS, more than 6,300 lb; Dragon C211, 4th flight; booster B1096, 8th flight; docking Thu Oct 15	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Confirmed	Spaceflight Now; Launch Library 2
Thu Oct 15, 7:44 p.m.	Falcon 9	USSF-481, US Space Force	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
NET October	Falcon 9	Bandwagon-5 rideshare	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
NET November	Falcon 9	Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
NET Sun Nov 8	Starship	Flight 15, Ship 42 and Booster 22; Musk says a ship catch will be attempted	Pad 2, Starbase, Texas	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)
NET Thu Dec 10	Starship	Flight 16 (Starlink Group 30-1), likely Ship 43 and Booster 23	Possibly LC-39A, Kennedy	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)

Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than (NET) month or an unofficial target. Sources: Spaceflight Now launch schedule (updated Oct 9); Launch Library 2 (The Space Devs), whose times are unofficial; NASASpaceflight, citing range-planning (CADENA) slides. The SDA launch listed for Saturday in Friday's table flew at 3:39 a.m. EDT. Pads: Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E), Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40), Launch Complex 39A (LC-39A).



The launch tower's arms catch a Super Heavy booster at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024. No ship has been caught yet.
PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

Starship status: a ship catch on Flight 15

Starship last flew on September 28. Flight 14 reached orbit and deployed 26 Starlink V3 satellites, though one engine shut down early. At the X Takeover event at Giga Texas on Saturday, Musk said the engine-out was "basically a failure in the flight computer software or engine computer software" and the heat shield held up, TSN Media reported from the interview:

> *"We don't know the exact launch date, but probably about four weeks or so. Four to six weeks is about right. Probably launches a little bit before Thanksgiving is my guess."*
>
> ELON MUSK · X TAKEOVER INTERVIEW, SATURDAY, VIA TSN MEDIA

"We catch the booster, which we've already proven ... but we're going to try to catch the ship, which is a super big deal. And if we do so, that'll be the first time that there's been full recovery of an orbital class rocket," he said. SpaceX has published no Flight 15 date or mission plan.

Hardware is the other clock. Ship 42 had all six engines removed and went back to the Massey's test site for a third

round of cryogenic proof testing, possibly after internal changes aimed at the Raptor Vacuum engine-outs seen on Flights 12 and 14, NASASpaceflight reported Friday; Booster 22 could static-fire as early as late this week. The Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) license covers the Flight 14 profile, and a changed mission such as a ship catch "could take a bit to get regulatory approval," NASASpaceflight wrote. Ship 40, from Flight 13, returned to Texas after 75 days at sea.

III · STARLINK

A license in Caracas, free service in Panama, a standoff in New Delhi

Starlink's weekend ran from a new market to disaster relief to a political fight, and Ukraine's reliance on the network was back in the news.

Venezuela makes it official

Venezuela's telecom regulator, Conatel, approved a general operating license and seven Ku-band concessions for Starlink, letting it operate through its local company, SpaceX VZ, S.C.A., rather than on temporary permits, Drive Tesla reported, citing a Friday government announcement. Starlink handed out more than 1,600 terminals after the June 24 earthquakes in La Guaira. SpaceX has not said when sales start or what service will cost.

Panama earthquake

After a magnitude 7.7 earthquake (U.S. Geological Survey) struck central Panama on Friday, Starlink said new and existing customers in affected areas will get free service through November 10 and that it is working with emergency agencies, Drive Tesla reported. Carrier +Móvil opened Starlink Mobile satellite texting to all its customers from Friday through Sunday.

India: "Prime Minister Ambani"

Musk kept up daily posts on Starlink's stalled Indian start. On Friday he addressed Reliance chairman Mukesh Ambani as "Dear Prime Minister Ambani" and asked whether he would "consider allowing Starlink to compete?", Mint reported. Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia replied that "India does not allow monopoly in any sector": Starlink, Jio Satcom and Eutelsat OneWeb all hold licences and can start once spectrum charges are set and each meets security conditions, the Hindustan Times reported. On Sunday India time Musk wrote that "if Starlink is too expensive in India, no one will buy it, so SpaceX will need to make pricing affordable" (The Hindu).

QUICK HIT

Ukraine. After Musk backed Trump's call for a new Ukrainian president, presidential adviser Serhii Beskrestnov said SpaceX will not cut off Starlink because Ukraine brings it significant revenue (Euromaidan Press; bne IntelliNews).

IV · AI & COMPUTE

Grok Bot learns to shop; Musk on why SpaceX bought Cursor

A new agent capability, and the X Takeover interview touched on AI and data centers in space.

"To buy stuff, you can just take a picture of your credit card, drop it in the chat and Grok @Bot will scour the Internet for the best deal on the item you want and order it," Musk posted Saturday; he added that Grok bought LEGO for him from LEGO's website, TeslaNorth reported, noting that he did not describe availability or spending safeguards.

In the X Takeover interview, Musk explained SpaceX's acquisition of Cursor as a source of AI training data and talent and discussed AI and data centers in space, according to the CEOInterviews summary of the 41-minute conversation.

A quiet weekend for filings

No new SEC or FAA actions since Friday morning. Comments on Starship at Cape Canaveral close Wednesday, and two FCC deadlines loom.

SEC

No filings for Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (CIK 0001181412) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Friday and 8:38 a.m. EDT Monday; SpaceX has not filed an 8-K on last week's spectrum agreement. Latest insider filings:

Form 4/A · Sep 30 · Antonio Gracias, director — Amends his September 15 report of the September 11 in-kind distribution of 42,790,223 shares by Valor entities. He reports 460,624,307 shares afterward. Filing

Form 4 · Sep 24 · Gwynne Shotwell, President and Chief Operating Officer — On September 22 she exercised options for 342,170 shares (138,900 at $8.3998, 74,405 at $11.20 and 128,865 at $19.40) and sold the same number at weighted-average prices of $151.15 to $154.72. She holds 2,472,035 shares afterward. Filing

FAA

No new FAA licenses, license modifications or environmental notices for SpaceX appeared on the FAA's commercial space pages or in the Federal Register since Friday morning. Latest on record:

Notice of intent · Sep 29 — Supplemental Environmental Impact Statement (SEIS) on Starship operations at Space Launch Complex 37, Cape Canaveral: up to 76 launches and 152 landings a year. Scoping comments are due Wednesday, October 14 (docket FAA-2026-10792; 91 FR 61551). Federal Register

Final environmental assessment · Sep 4 — Finding of no significant impact for Starship reentry contingency operations in the Pacific Ocean and an additional Starship landing trajectory (docket FAA-2026-6968; 91 FR 56939). Federal Register

FCC

Oct 8 · 800 MHz purchase — SpaceX's purchase of Grain's nationwide 800 MHz licenses is subject to FCC approval. Grain cites the FCC's July 2026 order approving its own purchase from T-Mobile, which set a competitive selection process and a conditional path to direct-to-device use. Grain · SpaceX

Oct 6 · Gen2 direct-to-device order — The Space and Wireless Telecommunications bureaus granted in part SpaceX's 15,000-satellite system. SpaceX must post a surety bond by November 4 and had 30 days from release to decline the conditioned grant; 7,500 satellites must operate by October 7, 2032, and all by October 7, 2035. U.S. service in the former EchoStar 2 GHz bands waits for Step Two of that deal to close. Exterra · Light Reading

Oct 29 · Open meeting — Votes on making 482 MHz more spectrum available for Supplemental Coverage from Space and on a proposed auction of 25 MHz at 1675–1695 and 2020–2025 MHz for terrestrial 5G, direct-to-device service or both. Broadband Breakfast

Takeaways

1. Falcon 9 launched 21 SDA satellites Saturday after a week of delays; booster B1103 landed at LZ-4.
2. Starlink 15-25 slipped again, to Monday evening; CRS-35 stays on Tuesday at 6:33 a.m. EDT.
3. Musk says Flight 15 will try to catch the ship; the unofficial target is no earlier than November 8.
4. Starlink won a Venezuelan license and offered free service in quake-hit Panama; the India standoff continued.
5. SPCX rose 1.25% Friday to $162.57; Barclays started coverage at Overweight with a $254 target.

SOURCES

Posts by @elonmusk and @NASASpaceflight as quoted by the outlets cited; Spaceflight Now, NASASpaceflight, Launch Library 2, NASA, TSN Media, Drive Tesla, Mint, Hindustan Times, The Hindu, bne IntelliNews, Euromaidan Press, TeslaNorth, Grain Management, SpaceX, Exterra, Light Reading, Broadband Breakfast; FAA, Federal Register; SEC EDGAR; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: NASA (public domain); Steve Jurvetson via Wikimedia Commons (CC BY 2.0).

The SpaceX Dispatch is an independent weekday digest of public news, X posts, regulatory filings and market data about Space Exploration Technologies Corp., and is not affiliated with the company. Quotes are verbatim; emoji in quoted posts are omitted for print. Market data are delayed and may be revised. Not investment advice.

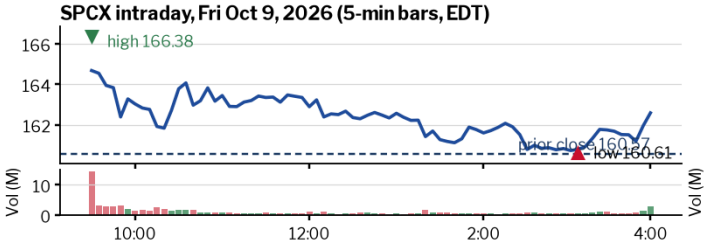
SPCX steadies after the spectrum deal

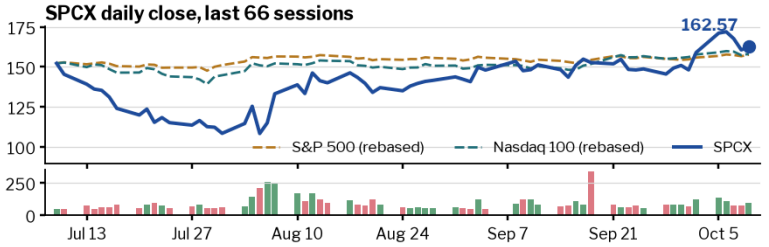
Shares rose 1.25% Friday on slightly above-average volume, as a lock-up tranche opened and Barclays began coverage at Overweight; they gave back an opening jump to $166.38.

CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$162.57	**+$2.00**	**$165.34**	**$166.38**	**$160.61**
Fri Oct 9, 4:00 p.m. EDT	*+1.25% vs $160.57*	*regular session*	*9:30 a.m. EDT bar*	*3:05 p.m. EDT bar*
VOLUME	**RANGE SINCE IPO**	**MARKET CAP**	**5-DAY / 1-MONTH**	**SINCE LISTING**
92.68M	**$105–$226**	**$2.14T**	**+2.27% / +9.71%**	**+20.4%**
+4.0% vs 30-session avg 89.15M	*no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)*	*13.18B Class A+B shares × close; $2.21T with Cursor shares*	*5 and 21 sessions*	*vs $135 IPO price; +1.01% vs first close*

SINCE IPO, OCT 9







As of close Oct 9, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 9 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	SINCE JUN 12
SPCX	**+1.25%**	**+2.27%**	**+9.71%**	**+1.01%**
S&P 500	+0.59%	+1.15%	+2.90%	+5.11%
Nasdaq 100	+0.51%	+0.24%	+6.11%	+4.21%
RKLB	−0.28%	−7.72%	+10.09%	−33.38%
ASTS	−10.48%	−12.81%	−14.93%	−38.16%
IRDM	−0.19%	−3.04%	+0.94%	+0.32%

OPTIONS SNAPSHOT (CBOE, RETRIEVED MON OCT 12, 8:38 A.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 12	61,198	29,515	0.48	30.2%	$170 / $155
Oct 14	18,913	10,246	0.54	40.6%	$162.50 / $160
Oct 16	378,701	407,674	1.08	42.9%	$170 / $100
All expiries	**2,212,731**	**2,308,396**	**1.04**		**30-day IV index 49.9**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 12

Strong buy	8
Buy	22
Hold	5
Sell	3
Strong sell	0
Mean (1 = strong buy)	1.79
Mean target (30 analysts)	$221.97 (+36.5%)
Median target	$225.00
High / low target	$450.00 / $118.00

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	181.00M
Change vs. prior report	+4.2%
Short % of float	2.71%
Days to cover	2.01
Held by insiders	12.73%
Held by institutions	48.45%
Alphabet, Jun 30	7.16%
Valor Management, Jun 30	6.54%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 9 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS −$1.10)	—
Forward P/E (EPS est. $1.99)	81.7
Price/sales (rev. $23.04B)	93.0
Beta	—
50-day average	$144.24 (+12.7%)
200-day average	—
Q3 EPS est. (16 analysts)	$0.17
Q3 revenue est. (17)	$12.98B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 9	Barclays	Overweight (initiated)	$254
Oct 9	TD Cowen	Buy	$200
Oct 8	Erste Group	Hold (initiated)	—
Oct 7	Susquehanna	Neutral	$144 to $173
Sep 30	Macquarie	Outperform	$250
Sep 28	Deutsche Bank	Buy	$235
Sep 28	CLSA	Outperform (initiated)	$250

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Fri Oct 16	Monthly options expiry
Sat Oct 24	**Lock-up tranche: up to 328.4M more**
Thu Oct 29	FCC open meeting: direct-to-device spectrum votes
Tue Nov 3	Q3 results (Yahoo estimate, not confirmed)
Wed Nov 4	FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites)
Tue Dec 8	180-day lock-up ends

Prices, volume, returns, averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 9). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest (Sep 30), ownership (Jun 30, % of Class A) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Mon Oct 12, 8:38 a.m. EDT; Erste Group via TheFly. P/E is price to earnings per share (EPS); price/sales uses trailing 12-month revenue. A dash marks a measure that does not apply yet: trailing P/E (negative EPS), beta and the 200-day average (listed Jun 12). Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) and IV as of Friday's close; P/C is put/call by OI; ATM IV at the $162.50 strike. Shares: 10-Q cover (7,696,293,669 Class A + 5,485,486,276 Class B, Jul 28); $2.21T adds 391,041,680 Cursor merger shares (8-K). IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4); 1.3B more shares unlock two trading days after Q3 results. FCC dates: Exterra.